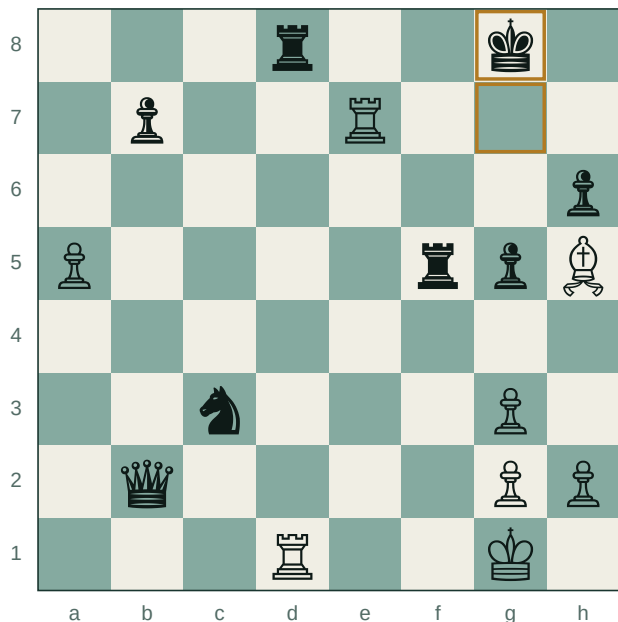


Deflection tactics: White, move 33

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 32...Kg8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33. Rxd8+ Rf8 34. Bf7+ Kh8 35. Rxf8+

33.Rxd8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on d8. Recorded reply: **33...Rf8**.

34.Bf7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **34...Kh8**.

35.Rxf8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +10. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +10**: the balance goes from -8 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on d8 and rook on f5. Check for tactical protection.